



Delaware County Council May 25th 2021

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UN0odFFpvSE
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Delaware County Council Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: May 25, 2021

Recording Start Time: 09:00:00

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Officer Scott Alexander called the Delaware County Council meeting to order at 09:00 AM on May 25, 2021, directing public comments to the county council email address (county_council_d-i-s-t at co.delaware.in.us).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Mr. Ballard, Ms. Chambers, Ms. Lassiter, Ms. Piper, Mr. Quakenbush, Mr. Webb, Mr. Alexander (Presiding Officer), Mr. Hughes, Ms. Flowers.
 - **Absent:** None noted.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Opening prayer and recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance led by Bill.
- **Approval of Agenda & Minutes:**

- Agenda approved via roll call (Mr. Ballard yes, Ms. Chambers yes, Ms. Lassiter yes, Ms. Piper yes, Mr. Quakenbush yes, Mr. Webb yes, Mr. Alexander yes).
- April regular minutes and executive session minutes approved via roll call (Ms. Chambers yes, Ms. Lassiter yes, Ms. Piper yes, Mr. Quakenbush yes, Mr. Webb yes, Mr. Ballard abstained, Mr. Alexander yes).

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:03:19 Resolution 2021-015: Canpack US LLC Economic Development Agreement & Inducement**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Bookout (Director of Economic Affairs), Tracy Lutton (Muncie Economic Development Alliance), Tom Johnson (Canpack US LLC), Joe Retz (County Attorney), Matt Eckerly (Baker Tilly), and Jim Staton (Secretary of Commerce).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presenters outlined a major economic development project involving Canpack US LLC establishing an 862,000 square foot (expandable to 1 million sq ft) manufacturing facility at Cowan Road and Fewson Road. The project represents a \$380 million to \$490 million capital investment and the creation of 345<U+2013>347 high-tech, premium full-time manufacturing positions with wages 25% higher than the Muncie average. The financing structure utilizes a 15-year TIF district where 75% of new revenues go toward bond repayment (fronted by the company, limiting county liability to the TIF pledge) and 25% is retained by the county. Environmental questionnaires and reviews were completed with Mundell Associates confirming operations fall within state guidelines.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Resolution 2021-015 (Inducement & Economic Development Agreement) **Approved by Voice Vote** following a motion by Ballard and second by Piper. *Later in the meeting 00:32:04, formal introduction and approval occurred via roll call:* Ms. Lassiter yes, Ms. Piper yes, Mr. Quakenbush yes, Mr. Webb yes, Mr. Ballard yes, Ms. Chambers yes, Mr. Alexander yes.
- **00:36:00 Living Greens Farm Economic Development / Shell Building Acquisition & Bond Introduction**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Bookout, Tracy Lutton, Joe Retz, and Matt Eckerly.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Living Greens Farm (from Minnesota) plans to acquire the 200,000 sq ft shell building on Fewson Road for a \$45 million investment, employing 120 people in vertical, aeroponic indoor farming (lettuces, microgreens, herbs) operational by October. The funding structure involves a 15-year TIF district pledge

of 70% toward bond debt, with 30% retained/managed, eliminating county carrying costs on the 7-year-old shell building and placing it on tax rolls.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Ordinance for the bond introduced. Motion to introduce Ordinance 2021-015 (Living Greens project) **Passed Unanimously** via roll call (Ms. Piper yes, Mr. Quakenbush yes, Mr. Webb yes, Mr. Ballard yes, Ms. Chambers yes, Ms. Lassiter yes, Mr. Alexander yes).
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

No general public comments were logged during the open public comment period.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **01:28:30** Jessica appointed to the Muncie Economic Development Commission (motioned by Ballard, seconded by Webb; approved via roll call: all ayes).
 - **01:29:31 Resolution 2021-014 (Sheriff's DROP Program):** Sheriff Tony Skinner presented the request to maintain the DROP program and remove/extend the sunset clause. Stan Brown (actuary) recommended a 5-year sunset if retained. Council member Ron expressed pension funding concerns, but a motion to approve the DROP program as presented passed via roll call (Ms. Chambers yes, Ms. Lassiter yes, Ms. Piper yes, Mr. Webb yes, Mr. Ballard yes, Mr. Alexander yes).
 - **01:44:55 Resolution 2021-016 (Electronic Participation Policy):** Bill presented the policy required by House Enrolled Act 1437 regarding electronic meetings/participation. Approved via roll call (Ms. Lassiter yes, Ms. Piper yes, Mr. Quakenbush no, Mr. Webb yes, Mr. Ballard yes, Ms. Chambers yes, Mr. Alexander yes).
 - **01:56:09** Lauren Timmy announced the annual Extension Board drive-through meeting on Friday, June 4th, from 11:00 AM to 1:00 PM at the fairgrounds.
 - **Transfers & Salary Adjustments:** Multiple departmental personnel transfers and line-item adjustments (Clerk, Circuit Court, Probation, EMS, Jail, Prosecutor, Public Defender) were reviewed and approved en masse or individually by roll call votes.
 - **Adjournment:** Official motion to adjourn made by Piper, seconded by Ballard, and approved by roll call (Ms. Piper yes, Mr. Quakenbush yes, Mr. Webb yes, Mr. Ballard yes, Ms. Chambers yes, Ms. Lassiter yes, Mr. Alexander yes).
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